

✓ Week-6 Assignment : Apache Spark

Apache Spark Architecture, Data Processing & Performance Optimization using PySpark

Dataset: Sample Superstore Dataset

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Technology Used:

Apache Spark (PySpark) Python Google Colab / Jupyter Notebook Apache Spark SQL CSV & Parquet File Formats

Objective:

To understand Apache Spark Architecture and perform efficient data processing using DataFrames, transformations, filtering, schema handling, lazy evaluation, and optimized storage formats (CSV & Parquet). The assignment also focuses on Spark performance concepts such as DAG, Predicate Pushdown, Shuffle operations, and best practices for handling large datasets.

Implementation:

✓ Step 1: Install Required Libraries

```
!pip install pyspark
```

```
Requirement already satisfied: pyspark in /usr/local/lib/python3.12/dist-pack  
Requirement already satisfied: py4j<0.10.9.10,>=0.10.9.7 in /usr/local/lib/py
```

✓ Step 2: Import Required Libraries

```
from pyspark.sql import SparkSession  
from pyspark.sql.functions import *
```

✓ Step 3: Create Spark Session

```
spark = SparkSession.builder \
    .appName("Week6 Spark Assignment") \
    .getOrCreate()
```

Verify Spark

spark

SparkSession - in-memory

SparkContext

[Spark UI](#)

Version

v4.0.3

Master

local[*]

AppName

Week6 Spark Assignment

✓ Step 4: upload the CSV

```
from google.colab import files
uploaded = files.upload()
```

Sample - Superstore.csv

Sample - Superstore.csv(text/csv) - 2287806 bytes, last modified: n/a - 100% done

Saving Sample - Superstore.csv to Sample - Superstore.csv

✓ Step 5: Load the Dataset

```
df = spark.read.csv(
    "Sample - Superstore.csv",
    header=True,
    inferSchema=True
)
```

✓ Step 6: Explore the Dataset

```
df.show(5)
df.printSchema()
df.count()
```

```
+-----+-----+-----+-----+-----+-----+
|Row ID|      Order ID|Order Date| Ship Date|      Ship Mode|Customer ID| Cus
+-----+-----+-----+-----+-----+-----+
|      1|CA-2016-152156| 11/8/2016|11/11/2016|    Second Class|    CG-12520|    C
|      2|CA-2016-152156| 11/8/2016|11/11/2016|    Second Class|    CG-12520|    C
|      3|CA-2016-138688| 6/12/2016| 6/16/2016|    Second Class|    DV-13045|Darri
|      4|US-2015-108966|10/11/2015|10/18/2015|Standard Class|    SO-20335| Sean
|      5|US-2015-108966|10/11/2015|10/18/2015|Standard Class|    SO-20335| Sean
+-----+-----+-----+-----+-----+-----+
```

only showing top 5 rows

root

```
-- Row ID: integer (nullable = true)
-- Order ID: string (nullable = true)
-- Order Date: string (nullable = true)
-- Ship Date: string (nullable = true)
-- Ship Mode: string (nullable = true)
-- Customer ID: string (nullable = true)
-- Customer Name: string (nullable = true)
-- Segment: string (nullable = true)
-- Country: string (nullable = true)
-- City: string (nullable = true)
-- State: string (nullable = true)
-- Postal Code: integer (nullable = true)
-- Region: string (nullable = true)
-- Product ID: string (nullable = true)
-- Category: string (nullable = true)
-- Sub-Category: string (nullable = true)
-- Product Name: string (nullable = true)
-- Sales: string (nullable = true)
-- Quantity: string (nullable = true)
-- Discount: string (nullable = true)
-- Profit: double (nullable = true)
```

9994

✓ Step 7: Select and Filter Data

```
from pyspark.sql.functions import col

df_processed.select("Product ID", "Category", "Sales").show()

df_processed.filter(col("Category") == "Technology").show()

df_processed.filter((col("Sales") > 1000) & (col("Region") == "West")).show()

df_processed.filter((col("Region") == "South") | (col("Category") == "Furnit
```

```
+-----+-----+-----+-----+-----+-----+
```

Product ID	Category	Sales
FUR-BO-10001798	Furniture	261.96
FUR-CH-10000454	Furniture	731.94
OFF-LA-10000240	Office Supplies	14.62
FUR-TA-10000577	Furniture	957.5775
OFF-ST-10000760	Office Supplies	22.368
FUR-FU-10001487	Furniture	48.86
OFF-AR-10002833	Office Supplies	7.28
TEC-PH-10002275	Technology	907.152
OFF-BI-10003910	Office Supplies	18.504
OFF-AP-10002892	Office Supplies	114.9
FUR-TA-10001539	Furniture	1706.184
TEC-PH-10002033	Technology	911.424
OFF-PA-10002365	Office Supplies	15.552
OFF-BI-10003656	Office Supplies	407.976
OFF-AP-10002311	Office Supplies	68.81
OFF-BI-10000756	Office Supplies	2.544
OFF-ST-10004186	Office Supplies	665.88
OFF-ST-10000107	Office Supplies	55.5
OFF-AR-10003056	Office Supplies	8.56
TEC-PH-10001949	Technology	213.48

only showing top 20 rows

Row ID	Order ID	Order Date	Ship Date	Ship Mode	Customer ID
8	CA-2014-115812	6/9/2014	6/14/2014	Standard Class	BH-11710
12	CA-2014-115812	6/9/2014	6/14/2014	Standard Class	BH-11710
20	CA-2014-143336	8/27/2014	9/1/2014	Second Class	ZD-21925
27	CA-2016-121755	1/16/2016	1/20/2016	Second Class	EH-13945
36	CA-2016-117590	12/8/2016	12/10/2016	First Class	GH-14485
41	CA-2015-117415	12/27/2015	12/31/2015	Standard Class	SN-20710
42	CA-2017-120999	9/10/2017	9/15/2017	Standard Class	LC-16930
45	CA-2016-118255	3/11/2016	3/13/2016	First Class	ON-18715
48	CA-2016-169194	6/20/2016	6/25/2016	Standard Class	LH-16900
49	CA-2016-169194	6/20/2016	6/25/2016	Standard Class	LH-16900
55	CA-2016-105816	12/11/2016	12/17/2016	Standard Class	JM-15265
60	CA-2016-111682	6/17/2016	6/18/2016	First Class	TB-21055
63	CA-2015-135545	11/24/2015	11/30/2015	Standard Class	KM-16720
69	CA-2014-106376	12/5/2014	12/10/2014	Standard Class	BS-11590
87	CA-2017-155558	10/26/2017	11/2/2017	Standard Class	PG-18895
91	CA-2016-109806	9/17/2016	9/22/2016	Standard Class	JS-15685
101	CA-2016-158568	8/29/2016	9/2/2016	Standard Class	RB-19465
104	US-2015-156867	11/13/2015	11/17/2015	Standard Class	LC-16870
107	CA-2017-119004	11/23/2017	11/28/2017	Standard Class	JM-15250
108	CA-2017-119004	11/23/2017	11/28/2017	Standard Class	JM-15250

only showing top 20 rows

Row ID	Order ID	Order Date	Ship Date	Ship Mode	Customer ID
11	CA-2014-115812	6/9/2014	6/14/2014	Standard Class	BH-11710
25	CA-2015-106320	9/25/2015	9/30/2015	Standard Class	EB-13870
68	CA-2014-106376	12/5/2014	12/10/2014	Standard Class	BS-11590

252	CA-2016-145625	9/11/2016	9/17/2016	Standard Class	KC-16540	Kel
283	CA-2015-130890	11/2/2015	11/6/2015	Standard Class	JO-15280	J

Step 8: Modify the DataFrame

```
from pyspark.sql.functions import col, when
from pyspark.sql.types import DoubleType

# Helper function to safely cast to DoubleType, converting non-numeric strings
def safe_cast_to_double(column_name):
    # Ensure raw string for regex to avoid SyntaxWarning
    return when(col(column_name).cast("string").rlike(r"^-?\d*\.\d+$"),
               col(column_name).cast(DoubleType())).otherwise(None)

# Rename Sales to Total_Sales
df = df.withColumnRenamed("Sales", "Total_Sales")

# Apply safe casting to Total_Sales, Quantity, and Discount
# This ensures that any malformed strings in these columns are converted to
df = df.withColumn("Total_Sales", safe_cast_to_double("Total_Sales"))
df = df.withColumn("Quantity", safe_cast_to_double("Quantity"))
df = df.withColumn("Discount", safe_cast_to_double("Discount"))

# Calculate Final_Price now that Total_Sales is correctly typed
df = df.withColumn("Final_Price", col("Total_Sales") * 1.18)

df.show(5)
```

Row ID	Order ID	Order Date	Ship Date	Ship Mode	Customer ID	Cus
1	CA-2016-152156	11/8/2016	11/11/2016	Second Class	CG-12520	C
2	CA-2016-152156	11/8/2016	11/11/2016	Second Class	CG-12520	C
3	CA-2016-138688	6/12/2016	6/16/2016	Second Class	DV-13045	Darri
4	US-2015-108966	10/11/2015	10/18/2015	Standard Class	SO-20335	Sean
5	US-2015-108966	10/11/2015	10/18/2015	Standard Class	SO-20335	Sean

only showing top 5 rows

Step 9: Handle Missing Values

```
from pyspark.sql.functions import col, when, count

df.select([
    count(when(col(c).isNull(), c)).alias(c)
    for c in df.columns
]).show()
```

```
df = df.na.drop()
```

```
+-----+-----+-----+-----+-----+-----+-----+-----+
|Row ID|Order ID|Order Date|Ship Date|Ship Mode|Customer ID|Customer Name|Seg
+-----+-----+-----+-----+-----+-----+-----+-----+
|      0|      0|      0|      0|      0|      0|      0|      0|
+-----+-----+-----+-----+-----+-----+-----+-----+
```

✓ Step 10: Perform Transformations and Actions

```
# Transformations
filtered_df = df.filter(col("Region") == "West").select("Customer Name", "To

# Actions
filtered_df.show()
filtered_df.count()
```

```
+-----+-----+
|      Customer Name|Total_Sales|
+-----+-----+
|  Darrin Van Huff|      14.62|
|  Brosina Hoffman|      48.86|
|  Brosina Hoffman|       7.28|
|  Brosina Hoffman|     907.152|
|  Brosina Hoffman|     18.504|
|  Brosina Hoffman|     114.9|
|  Brosina Hoffman|    1706.184|
|  Brosina Hoffman|     911.424|
|    Irene Maddox|     407.976|
| Alejandro Grove|       55.5|
| Zuschuss Donatelli|      8.56|
| Zuschuss Donatelli|     213.48|
| Zuschuss Donatelli|      22.72|
|    Emily Burns|    1044.63|
|    Eric Hoffmann|     11.648|
|    Eric Hoffmann|      90.57|
|    Ruben Ausman|      77.88|
|    Kunst Miller|      13.98|
|    Kunst Miller|     25.824|
|    Kunst Miller|     146.73|
+-----+-----+
```

```
only showing top 20 rows
3203
```

✓ Step 11: Save Data in CSV and Parquet

```
df.write.mode("overwrite").option("header", True).csv("output/csv_output")

df.write.mode("overwrite").parquet("output/parquet_output")
```

Step 12: Read Parquet and Demonstrate Predicate Pushdown

```
parquet_df = spark.read.parquet("output/parquet_output")

parquet_df.filter(col("Region") == "West").show()

parquet_df.filter(col("Region") == "West").explain(True)
```

```
+-----+-----+-----+-----+-----+-----+
|Row ID|      Order ID|Order Date| Ship Date|      Ship Mode|Customer ID|
+-----+-----+-----+-----+-----+-----+
|      3|CA-2016-138688| 6/12/2016| 6/16/2016|    Second Class|    DV-13045|    Da
|      6|CA-2014-115812|  6/9/2014| 6/14/2014| Standard Class|    BH-11710|    Br
|      7|CA-2014-115812|  6/9/2014| 6/14/2014| Standard Class|    BH-11710|    Br
|      8|CA-2014-115812|  6/9/2014| 6/14/2014| Standard Class|    BH-11710|    Br
|      9|CA-2014-115812|  6/9/2014| 6/14/2014| Standard Class|    BH-11710|    Br
|     10|CA-2014-115812|  6/9/2014| 6/14/2014| Standard Class|    BH-11710|    Br
|     11|CA-2014-115812|  6/9/2014| 6/14/2014| Standard Class|    BH-11710|    Br
|     12|CA-2014-115812|  6/9/2014| 6/14/2014| Standard Class|    BH-11710|    Br
|     14|CA-2016-161389|12/5/2016|12/10/2016| Standard Class|    IM-15070|
|     18|CA-2014-167164| 5/13/2014| 5/15/2014|    Second Class|    AG-10270|    Al
|     19|CA-2014-143336| 8/27/2014|  9/1/2014|    Second Class|    ZD-21925|Zusch
|     20|CA-2014-143336| 8/27/2014|  9/1/2014|    Second Class|    ZD-21925|Zusch
|     21|CA-2014-143336| 8/27/2014|  9/1/2014|    Second Class|    ZD-21925|Zusch
|     25|CA-2015-106320| 9/25/2015| 9/30/2015| Standard Class|    EB-13870|
|     26|CA-2016-121755| 1/16/2016| 1/20/2016|    Second Class|    EH-13945|
|     27|CA-2016-121755| 1/16/2016| 1/20/2016|    Second Class|    EH-13945|
|     43|CA-2016-101343| 7/17/2016| 7/22/2016| Standard Class|    RA-19885|
|     63|CA-2015-135545|11/24/2015|11/30/2015| Standard Class|    KM-16720|
|     64|CA-2015-135545|11/24/2015|11/30/2015| Standard Class|    KM-16720|
|     65|CA-2015-135545|11/24/2015|11/30/2015| Standard Class|    KM-16720|
+-----+-----+-----+-----+-----+-----+
only showing top 20 rows
== Parsed Logical Plan ==
'Filter ``=`('Region, West)
+- Relation [Row ID#3744,Order ID#3745,Order Date#3746,Ship Date#3747,Ship Mo
```

```
== Analyzed Logical Plan ==
Row ID: int, Order ID: string, Order Date: string, Ship Date: string, Ship Mo
Filter (Region#3756 = West)
+- Relation [Row ID#3744,Order ID#3745,Order Date#3746,Ship Date#3747,Ship Mo

== Optimized Logical Plan ==
Filter (isnotnull(Region#3756) AND (Region#3756 = West))
+- Relation [Row ID#3744,Order ID#3745,Order Date#3746,Ship Date#3747,Ship Mo

== Physical Plan ==
*(1) Filter (isnotnull(Region#3756) AND (Region#3756 = West))
+- *(1) ColumnarToRow
   +- FileScan parquet [Row ID#3744,Order ID#3745,Order Date#3746,Ship Date#3
```


Step 13: Compare CSV and Parquet Performance

```
# Read CSV
csv_df = spark.read.csv(
    "/content/Sample - Superstore.csv",
    header=True,
    inferSchema=True
)

# Read Parquet
parquet_df = spark.read.parquet("output/parquet_output")

# Compare number of records
print("CSV Records:", csv_df.count())
print("Parquet Records:", parquet_df.count())

# Display sample data
csv_df.show(5)
parquet_df.show(5)
```

CSV Records: 9994

Parquet Records: 9994

Row ID	Order ID	Order Date	Ship Date	Ship Mode	Customer ID	Customer Name
1	CA-2016-152156	11/8/2016	11/11/2016	Second Class	CG-12520	Chen
2	CA-2016-152156	11/8/2016	11/11/2016	Second Class	CG-12520	Chen
3	CA-2016-138688	6/12/2016	6/16/2016	Second Class	DV-13045	Darri
4	US-2015-108966	10/11/2015	10/18/2015	Standard Class	SO-20335	Sean
5	US-2015-108966	10/11/2015	10/18/2015	Standard Class	SO-20335	Sean

only showing top 5 rows

Row ID	Order ID	Order Date	Ship Date	Ship Mode	Customer ID	Customer Name
1	CA-2016-152156	11/8/2016	11/11/2016	Second Class	CG-12520	Chen
2	CA-2016-152156	11/8/2016	11/11/2016	Second Class	CG-12520	Chen
3	CA-2016-138688	6/12/2016	6/16/2016	Second Class	DV-13045	Darri
4	US-2015-108966	10/11/2015	10/18/2015	Standard Class	SO-20335	Sean
5	US-2015-108966	10/11/2015	10/18/2015	Standard Class	SO-20335	Sean

only showing top 5 rows

Step 14: Build the Spark Data Pipeline

```
from pyspark.sql.functions import col

pipeline_df = (
```

```

    df
    .filter(col("Category") == "Technology")
    .withColumn("Final_Price", col("Sales") * 1.18)
)

pipeline_df.write.mode("overwrite").parquet("output/final_pipeline")

```

```
pipeline_df.printSchema()
```

```

root
|-- Row ID: integer (nullable = true)
|-- Order ID: string (nullable = true)
|-- Order Date: string (nullable = true)
|-- Ship Date: string (nullable = true)
|-- Ship Mode: string (nullable = true)
|-- Customer ID: string (nullable = true)
|-- Customer Name: string (nullable = true)
|-- Segment: string (nullable = true)
|-- Country: string (nullable = true)
|-- City: string (nullable = true)
|-- State: string (nullable = true)
|-- Postal Code: integer (nullable = true)
|-- Region: string (nullable = true)
|-- Product ID: string (nullable = true)
|-- Category: string (nullable = true)
|-- Sub-Category: string (nullable = true)
|-- Product Name: string (nullable = true)
|-- Sales: double (nullable = true)
|-- Quantity: integer (nullable = true)
|-- Discount: double (nullable = true)
|-- Profit: double (nullable = true)
|-- Final_Price: double (nullable = true)

```

Verify the saved data

```
spark.read.parquet("output/final_pipeline").show(5)
```

```

+-----+-----+-----+-----+-----+-----+-----+
|Row ID|      Order ID|Order Date| Ship Date|      Ship Mode|Customer ID|
+-----+-----+-----+-----+-----+-----+-----+
|      8|CA-2014-115812| 6/9/2014| 6/14/2014|Standard Class|  BH-11710| Br
|     12|CA-2014-115812| 6/9/2014| 6/14/2014|Standard Class|  BH-11710| Br
|     20|CA-2014-143336| 8/27/2014| 9/1/2014|  Second Class|  ZD-21925| Zusch
|     27|CA-2016-121755| 1/16/2016| 1/20/2016|  Second Class|  EH-13945|
|     36|CA-2016-117590| 12/8/2016| 12/10/2016|  First Class|  GH-14485|
+-----+-----+-----+-----+-----+-----+-----+
only showing top 5 rows

```

✓ Step 15: Performance Insights & Best Practices

Performance Insights

1. Spark uses Lazy Evaluation, executing transformations only when an action (show(), count(), etc.) is called.
2. Parquet files provide faster query performance and consume less storage than CSV due to their columnar format and compression.
3. Predicate Pushdown filters data at the storage level, reducing the amount of data loaded into memory.
4. Wide Transformations (e.g., groupBy()) involve data shuffling, while Narrow Transformations (e.g., filter(), select()) do not.

Best Practices

1. Use .show(5) for previewing data instead of .collect() on large datasets.
2. Define the schema or use inferSchema=True while reading data.
3. Prefer Parquet over CSV for storing processed datasets.
4. Filter data as early as possible to minimize processing.
5. Avoid unnecessary transformations and repeated actions to improve performance.

Week-6 : Spark Assignment Questions and Answers (Q1 to Q15)

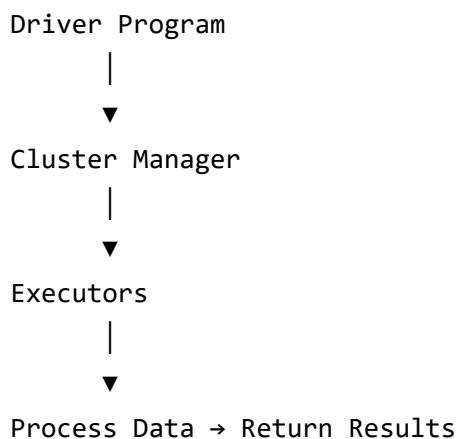
Q1. Explain the roles of the Driver, Cluster Manager, and Executor in a Spark application.

Answer:

Spark follows a **Master-Worker Architecture** where different components work together to execute distributed applications.

Component	Role
Driver	The main program that creates the Spark Session, converts code into tasks, schedules jobs, and
Cluster Manager	Allocates resources (CPU and memory) across the cluster and launches Executors. Examples in
Executor	Worker processes running on cluster nodes. They execute tasks, store cached data, and send r

Execution Flow



Q2. How does Spark's Lazy Evaluation strategy improve performance?

Answer:

Spark does **not execute transformations immediately**. Instead, it records them and creates a **Directed Acyclic Graph (DAG)**. Execution begins only when an **Action** (such as `show()` or `count()`) is called.

Advantages

- Minimizes unnecessary computations.
- Optimizes execution using DAG.
- Reduces disk I/O.
- Combines multiple transformations into a single execution plan.

Example

```

filtered_df = df.filter(col("Region") == "West") \
                  .select("Customer Name", "Sales")

# No execution yet

filtered_df.show()      # Action triggers execution
  
```

```

+-----+-----+
| Customer Name | Sales |
  
```

```
+-----+-----+
| Darrin Van Huff| 14.62|
| Brosina Hoffman| 48.86|
| Brosina Hoffman| 7.28|
| Brosina Hoffman| 907.152|
| Brosina Hoffman| 18.504|
| Brosina Hoffman| 114.9|
| Brosina Hoffman| 1706.184|
| Brosina Hoffman| 911.424|
| Irene Maddox| 407.976|
| Alejandro Grove| 55.5|
| Zuschuss Donatelli| 8.56|
| Zuschuss Donatelli| 213.48|
| Zuschuss Donatelli| 22.72|
| Emily Burns| 1044.63|
| Eric Hoffmann| 11.648|
| Eric Hoffmann| 90.57|
| Ruben Ausman| 77.88|
| Kunst Miller| 13.98|
| Kunst Miller| 25.824|
| Kunst Miller| 146.73|
+-----+-----+
```

only showing top 20 rows

Q3. Read a CSV file with Header and Infer Schema

Answer

- `header=True` → Uses the first row as column names.
- `inferSchema=True` → Automatically detects column data types.

```
df = spark.read.csv(
    "/content/Sample - Superstore.csv",
    header=True,
    inferSchema=True
)
```

Q4. Difference between CSV and Parquet

Answer

Feature	CSV	Parquet
Storage Type	Row-based	Columnar

Compression	No	yes
Schema	Not Stored	Stored
Query Performance	Slower	Faster
Storage Size	Larger	Smaller
Analytics	Less Efficient	Highly Efficient

Why Parquet is Faster?

Parquet reads only the required columns, reducing disk I/O and improving query performance. It also supports **Predicate Pushdown**, making it ideal for big data analytics.

Q5. Select `product_id` and `price` where category is 'Electronics'

Answer

```
from pyspark.sql.functions import col

df.filter(col("Category") == "Technology") \
  .select("Product ID", "Sales") \
  .show()
```

```
+-----+-----+
|   Product ID|   Sales|
+-----+-----+
|TEC-PH-10002275| 907.152|
|TEC-PH-10002033| 911.424|
|TEC-PH-10001949|  213.48|
|TEC-AC-10003027|   90.57|
|TEC-PH-10004977|1097.544|
|TEC-PH-10000486| 371.168|
|TEC-PH-10004093| 147.168|
|TEC-AC-10000171|   45.98|
|TEC-AC-10002167|    45|
|TEC-PH-10003988|   21.8|
|TEC-PH-10002447|1029.95|
|TEC-AC-10002167|    30|
|TEC-AC-10004633|   13.98|
|TEC-PH-10002726|167.968|
|TEC-AC-10001998|   19.99|
|TEC-PH-10004093|  73.584|
|TEC-AC-10001767|  95.976|
|TEC-AC-10001552|238.896|
|TEC-AC-10003499|  74.112|
|TEC-PH-10002844|  27.992|
```

```

+-----+-----+
only showing top 20 rows

```

Q6. Rename a column and cast data type

Answer

```

from pyspark.sql.functions import col

# Rename Sales to Total_Sales
df = df.withColumnRenamed("Sales", "Total_Sales")

# Cast Total_Sales to Double
df = df.withColumn(
    "Total_Sales",
    col("Total_Sales").cast("double")
)

df.show(5)

```

```

+-----+-----+-----+-----+-----+-----+-----+
|Row ID|      Order ID|Order Date| Ship Date|      Ship Mode|Customer ID| Cus
+-----+-----+-----+-----+-----+-----+-----+
|      1|CA-2016-152156| 11/8/2016|11/11/2016|    Second Class|    CG-12520|    C
|      2|CA-2016-152156| 11/8/2016|11/11/2016|    Second Class|    CG-12520|    C
|      3|CA-2016-138688| 6/12/2016| 6/16/2016|    Second Class|    DV-13045|Darri
|      4|US-2015-108966|10/11/2015|10/18/2015|Standard Class|    SO-20335| Sean
|      5|US-2015-108966|10/11/2015|10/18/2015|Standard Class|    SO-20335| Sean
+-----+-----+-----+-----+-----+-----+-----+
only showing top 5 rows

```

Q7. How does Spark's DAG provide Fault Tolerance?

Answer

Spark maintains a **Lineage Graph (DAG)** that records every transformation applied to the data.

If an Executor or worker node fails:

- Spark identifies the lost partition.
- Recomputes only the missing partition using the lineage graph.
- Does **not** recompute the entire dataset

Does not recompute the entire dataset.

Benefits

- Automatic recovery.
- No data replication required.
- Efficient fault recovery.

Q8. Filter orders where Status is 'Completed' and Amount > 1000

Answer

```
from pyspark.sql.functions import col, when
from pyspark.sql.types import DoubleType

# Helper function to safely cast to DoubleType, converting non-numeric string
def safe_cast_to_double(column_name):
    # Ensure raw string for regex to avoid SyntaxWarning
    return when(col(column_name).cast("string").rlike(r"^-?\d*\.\d+$"),
                col(column_name).cast(DoubleType())).otherwise(None)

# Apply safe casting to the 'Sales' column before filtering
df_fresh_processed = df_fresh.withColumn("Sales", safe_cast_to_double("Sales"))

df_fresh_processed.filter(col("Sales") > 1000).show()
```

Row ID	Order ID	Order Date	Ship Date	Ship Mode	Customer ID	C
11	CA-2014-115812	6/9/2014	6/14/2014	Standard Class	BH-11710	Bro
25	CA-2015-106320	9/25/2015	9/30/2015	Standard Class	EB-13870	
28	US-2015-150630	9/17/2015	9/21/2015	Standard Class	TB-21520	Tra
36	CA-2016-117590	12/8/2016	12/10/2016	First Class	GH-14485	
55	CA-2016-105816	12/11/2016	12/17/2016	Standard Class	JM-15265	Ja
68	CA-2014-106376	12/5/2014	12/10/2014	Standard Class	BS-11590	B
150	CA-2016-114489	12/5/2016	12/9/2016	Standard Class	JE-16165	Ju
166	CA-2014-139892	9/8/2014	9/12/2014	Standard Class	BM-11140	
168	CA-2014-139892	9/8/2014	9/12/2014	Standard Class	BM-11140	
216	CA-2015-146262	1/2/2015	1/9/2015	Standard Class	VW-21775	Vic
245	CA-2014-131926	6/1/2014	6/6/2014	Second Class	DW-13480	D
248	CA-2014-131926	6/1/2014	6/6/2014	Second Class	DW-13480	D
252	CA-2016-145625	9/11/2016	9/17/2016	Standard Class	KC-16540	Kel
263	US-2014-106992	9/19/2014	9/21/2014	Second Class	SB-20290	
264	US-2014-106992	9/19/2014	9/21/2014	Second Class	SB-20290	
282	US-2015-161991	9/26/2015	9/28/2015	Second Class	SC-20725	Steve
283	CA-2015-130890	11/2/2015	11/6/2015	Standard Class	JO-15280	J

319	CA-2014-164973	11/4/2014	11/9/2014	Standard Class	NM-18445	
354	CA-2016-129714	9/1/2016	9/3/2016	First Class	AB-10060	Ada
370	CA-2016-155516	10/21/2016	10/21/2016	Same Day	MK-17905	Mic

only showing top 20 rows

Q9. Explain Predicate Pushdown

Answer

Predicate Pushdown is an optimization technique used mainly with **Parquet** and other columnar storage formats.

Instead of loading the entire dataset into memory, Spark sends the filter condition directly to the storage layer. Only matching rows are read.

Benefits

- Reads less data.
- Reduces memory usage.
- Improves query execution speed.
- Minimizes disk I/O.

Example

```
parquet_df.filter(col("Region") == "West").show()
```

Row ID	Order ID	Order Date	Ship Date	Ship Mode	Customer ID	
3	CA-2016-138688	6/12/2016	6/16/2016	Second Class	DV-13045	Da
6	CA-2014-115812	6/9/2014	6/14/2014	Standard Class	BH-11710	Br
7	CA-2014-115812	6/9/2014	6/14/2014	Standard Class	BH-11710	Br
8	CA-2014-115812	6/9/2014	6/14/2014	Standard Class	BH-11710	Br
9	CA-2014-115812	6/9/2014	6/14/2014	Standard Class	BH-11710	Br
10	CA-2014-115812	6/9/2014	6/14/2014	Standard Class	BH-11710	Br
11	CA-2014-115812	6/9/2014	6/14/2014	Standard Class	BH-11710	Br
12	CA-2014-115812	6/9/2014	6/14/2014	Standard Class	BH-11710	Br
14	CA-2016-161389	12/5/2016	12/10/2016	Standard Class	IM-15070	
18	CA-2014-167164	5/13/2014	5/15/2014	Second Class	AG-10270	Al
19	CA-2014-143336	8/27/2014	9/1/2014	Second Class	ZD-21925	Zusch
20	CA-2014-143336	8/27/2014	9/1/2014	Second Class	ZD-21925	Zusch
21	CA-2014-143336	8/27/2014	9/1/2014	Second Class	ZD-21925	Zusch
25	CA-2015-106320	9/25/2015	9/30/2015	Standard Class	EB-13870	
26	CA-2016-121755	1/16/2016	1/20/2016	Second Class	EH-13945	
27	CA-2016-121755	1/16/2016	1/20/2016	Second Class	EH-13945	
43	CA-2016-101343	7/17/2016	7/22/2016	Standard Class	RA-19885	

```

|      63|CA-2015-135545|11/24/2015|11/30/2015|Standard Class|KM-16720|
|      64|CA-2015-135545|11/24/2015|11/30/2015|Standard Class|KM-16720|
|      65|CA-2015-135545|11/24/2015|11/30/2015|Standard Class|KM-16720|
+-----+-----+-----+-----+-----+-----+
only showing top 20 rows

```

Q10. Add a new column `final_price`

Answer

```

from pyspark.sql.functions import col

df = df.withColumn(
    "final_price",
    col("Total_Sales") * 1.18
)

df.show()

```

```

+-----+-----+-----+-----+-----+-----+
|Row ID|      Order ID|Order Date| Ship Date|      Ship Mode|Customer ID|
+-----+-----+-----+-----+-----+-----+
|      1|CA-2016-152156| 11/8/2016|11/11/2016|    Second Class|CG-12520|
|      2|CA-2016-152156| 11/8/2016|11/11/2016|    Second Class|CG-12520|
|      3|CA-2016-138688|  6/12/2016|  6/16/2016|    Second Class|DV-13045|    Da
|      4|US-2015-108966|10/11/2015|10/18/2015|Standard Class|SO-20335|    S
|      5|US-2015-108966|10/11/2015|10/18/2015|Standard Class|SO-20335|    S
|      6|CA-2014-115812|  6/9/2014|  6/14/2014|Standard Class|BH-11710|    Br
|      7|CA-2014-115812|  6/9/2014|  6/14/2014|Standard Class|BH-11710|    Br
|      8|CA-2014-115812|  6/9/2014|  6/14/2014|Standard Class|BH-11710|    Br
|      9|CA-2014-115812|  6/9/2014|  6/14/2014|Standard Class|BH-11710|    Br
|     10|CA-2014-115812|  6/9/2014|  6/14/2014|Standard Class|BH-11710|    Br
|     11|CA-2014-115812|  6/9/2014|  6/14/2014|Standard Class|BH-11710|    Br
|     12|CA-2014-115812|  6/9/2014|  6/14/2014|Standard Class|BH-11710|    Br
|     13|CA-2017-114412|  4/15/2017|  4/20/2017|Standard Class|AA-10480|
|     14|CA-2016-161389| 12/5/2016|12/10/2016|Standard Class|IM-15070|
|     15|US-2015-118983|11/22/2015|11/26/2015|Standard Class|HP-14815|
|     16|US-2015-118983|11/22/2015|11/26/2015|Standard Class|HP-14815|
|     17|CA-2014-105893|11/11/2014|11/18/2014|Standard Class|PK-19075|
|     18|CA-2014-167164|  5/13/2014|  5/15/2014|    Second Class|AG-10270|    Al
|     19|CA-2014-143336|  8/27/2014|  9/1/2014|    Second Class|ZD-21925|Zusch
|     20|CA-2014-143336|  8/27/2014|  9/1/2014|    Second Class|ZD-21925|Zusch
+-----+-----+-----+-----+-----+-----+
only showing top 20 rows

```

Q11. Difference between Transformations and Actions

Answer

Transformations	Actions
Create a new DataFrame	Execute the computation
Lazy Evaluation	Trigger execution
Return a DataFrame	Return values or display results

Examples

```
#### Transformations
```

```
df.filter(col("Total_Sales") > 1000)
```

```
df.select("Customer Name", "Total_Sales")
```

```
#### Actions
```

```
df.show()
```

```
df.count()
```

```
+-----+-----+-----+-----+-----+-----+
|Row ID|      Order ID|Order Date| Ship Date|      Ship Mode|Customer ID|
+-----+-----+-----+-----+-----+-----+
|  1|CA-2016-152156| 11/8/2016|11/11/2016|  Second Class|CG-12520|
|  2|CA-2016-152156| 11/8/2016|11/11/2016|  Second Class|CG-12520|
|  3|CA-2016-138688|  6/12/2016|  6/16/2016|  Second Class|DV-13045| Da
|  4|US-2015-108966|10/11/2015|10/18/2015|Standard Class|SO-20335| S
|  5|US-2015-108966|10/11/2015|10/18/2015|Standard Class|SO-20335| S
|  6|CA-2014-115812|  6/9/2014|  6/14/2014|Standard Class|BH-11710| Br
|  7|CA-2014-115812|  6/9/2014|  6/14/2014|Standard Class|BH-11710| Br
|  8|CA-2014-115812|  6/9/2014|  6/14/2014|Standard Class|BH-11710| Br
|  9|CA-2014-115812|  6/9/2014|  6/14/2014|Standard Class|BH-11710| Br
| 10|CA-2014-115812|  6/9/2014|  6/14/2014|Standard Class|BH-11710| Br
| 11|CA-2014-115812|  6/9/2014|  6/14/2014|Standard Class|BH-11710| Br
| 12|CA-2014-115812|  6/9/2014|  6/14/2014|Standard Class|BH-11710| Br
| 13|CA-2017-114412|  4/15/2017|  4/20/2017|Standard Class|AA-10480|
| 14|CA-2016-161389| 12/5/2016|12/10/2016|Standard Class|IM-15070|
| 15|US-2015-118983|11/22/2015|11/26/2015|Standard Class|HP-14815|
| 16|US-2015-118983|11/22/2015|11/26/2015|Standard Class|HP-14815|
| 17|CA-2014-105893|11/11/2014|11/18/2014|Standard Class|PK-19075|
| 18|CA-2014-167164|  5/13/2014|  5/15/2014|  Second Class|AG-10270| Al
| 19|CA-2014-143336|  8/27/2014|  9/1/2014|  Second Class|ZD-21925| Zusch
| 20|CA-2014-143336|  8/27/2014|  9/1/2014|  Second Class|ZD-21925| Zusch
+-----+-----+-----+-----+-----+-----+
```

```
only showing top 20 rows
9994
```

Q12. Load Parquet → Filter Null Values → Save as CSV

Answer

```
from pyspark.sql.functions import col

parquet_df_read = spark.read.parquet("output/parquet_output")

parquet_df_read.filter(
    col("Sales").isNotNull()
).write.mode("overwrite") \
    .option("header", True) \
    .csv("output/filtered_parquet_to_csv")
```

Q13. Difference between Client Mode and Cluster Mode

Answer

Client Mode	Cluster Mode
Driver runs on the local machine.	Driver runs inside the cluster.
Suitable for development and testing.	Suitable for production environments.
If the client disconnects, the application stops.	Continues running even if the client disconnects.
Easier debugging.	Better scalability and fault tolerance.

Q14. Filter Region is 'North' OR Priority is 'High'

Answer

Note: The Sample Superstore dataset does not contain a Priority column. Therefore, the query has been adapted to filter records based on the available Region column.

```
df.filter(
    col("Region") == "North"
).show()
```

```

+-----+-----+-----+-----+-----+-----+-----+-----+
|Row ID|Order ID|Order Date|Ship Date|Ship Mode|Customer ID|Customer Name|Seg
+-----+-----+-----+-----+-----+-----+-----+-----+
+-----+-----+-----+-----+-----+-----+-----+-----+

```

Q15. Why use `.show(5)` instead of `.collect()` on large datasets?

Answer

The `.show(5)` function displays only the first **five rows** of a DataFrame, whereas `.collect()` retrieves **all rows** from every Executor to the Driver.

For very large datasets (GBs or TBs), using `.collect()` can:

- Consume excessive Driver memory.
- Cause **OutOfMemoryError**.
- Slow down application performance.
- Increase network traffic.

Key Learning Outcomes

- Understood the **Apache Spark Architecture**, including the roles of the Driver, Cluster Manager, and Executors.
- Learned Spark's **Lazy Evaluation** and **DAG execution** for optimized processing.
- Performed DataFrame operations such as **reading, filtering, selecting, renaming, casting, and adding new columns**.
- Applied **data cleaning** techniques by handling null values and schema management.
- Differentiated between **Transformations** and **Actions** in Spark.
- Compared **CSV** and **Parquet** file formats and understood the performance benefits of Parquet.
- Explored **Predicate Pushdown, Shuffle**, and other Spark performance optimization concepts.
- Built an end-to-end **Spark data pipeline** for reading, transforming, filtering, and saving processed data.

Followed Spark best practices for efficiently processing large datasets.

- Followed Spark best practices for efficiently processing large datasets.

Conclusion

This assignment provided practical experience with **Apache Spark Fundamentals** and **PySpark DataFrame operations**. It covered Spark architecture, data transformations, schema handling, performance optimization, and file formats. By implementing an end-to-end data pipeline, the assignment strengthened the understanding of scalable data processing and industry-standard Spark practices, forming a strong foundation for advanced data engineering and big data applications.